THE JOPETNAH FOUNDATION

EDUCATION & YOUTH DEVELOPMENT · READ TO LEAD

Help us set up community libraries.

Every child deserves a place to read, and a book to take home.

The need

TJF has identified a serious shortage of books, reading spaces and reading support in the underserved communities it plans to serve in Uganda. Without them, children struggle to build the literacy that everything else in school depends on, and caregivers have little to read with them at home. Library setup is one of the most practical, visible ways to change that, and it is a priority for our founder and Executive Director.

What Read to Lead will do

Read to Lead is TJF's proposed literacy and reading-access initiative under the Education & Youth Development pillar. Its four areas of focus:

Community libraries and mobile reading resources

Welcoming reading spaces in or near schools and community centres, with mobile book boxes for reaching further.

Reading clubs and storytelling

Regular, volunteer-led sessions that make reading social and fun.

Book access and circulation

Simple, well-kept systems so books can be borrowed, returned and shared fairly.

Caregiver and volunteer engagement

Training and support so parents, caregivers and volunteers can lead reading at home and in the community.

Our larger aim: a community centre and library

TJF is particularly interested in serving a community of about **1,000 children and adults** by building a community centre with a library at its heart: a safe, welcoming place to read, learn, meet and take part in community activities. It would bring together Read to Lead, our mentoring and digital-skills work, and the families those programmes serve. Building and equipping a centre will require significant funding, which TJF will seek at the appropriate stage, once its legal, governance and financial systems are ready. The design, site and costs have yet to be confirmed with the community and partners.

How you can help

Give in kind

- Age-appropriate storybooks, early readers, textbooks and reference books
- Books in local languages, and books reflecting local life
- Shelving, reading mats, storage trunks and book-repair supplies
- Laptops or tablets for cataloguing, if available

Give skills, time and connections

- Librarians and educators to help design and train
- Storytelling and reading-club volunteers
- Publishers, libraries and book charities willing to partner
- Schools or community spaces able to host a library

Funders and institutional partners interested in the community centre are welcome to open a conversation now. No funds are being accepted at this stage.

> **Please contact us before sending any books or equipment.** We match every gift to a real community need, so we can say what is most useful, and arrange safe delivery and a receipt. Write to **thejopetnahfoundation@gmail.com** with "Read to Lead" in the subject line, or visit the Give in kind page: the-jopetnah-foundation-tjf.github.io/the-jopetnah-foundation/in-kind.html

Read to Lead is in the design stage; locations, quantities and timing will be confirmed with communities and partners and depend on resources and approvals. TJF is in its founding stage and in the final stages of its legal registration as a Company Limited by Guarantee and NGO in Uganda. Online donations are not active; this is a call for in-kind support and partnership. Library work connects to our other Education programmes, Jopetnah Scholars and Future-Ready Labs.